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Editorial Office
Machine Learning and Knowledge Extraction

Dear Editors,

Please consider my Article, *ArrowFlow: Training Ranking Filters with Position Votes*, for publication in *Machine Learning and Knowledge Extraction*.

ArrowFlow learns ranking filters through weighted position votes. The manuscript explains the learning rule, its relation to the Borda count and Arrow’s impossibility theorem, and the limits of its component guarantees. It also shows how discrete motions from a ranking layer can train a neural encoder through target scores without differentiating the sort. These contributions concern learning algorithms and representations, central topics of MAKE.

Nested evaluations on seventeen datasets and matched controls show that the motions carry useful learning information. The trained encoder classifier outperforms its untrained counterpart on all seventeen datasets, significantly on eleven. Swapping the encoder into ArrowFlow raises mean accuracy on eleven datasets, significantly on one, with no significant decrease. The paper also reports the method’s limitations: the fixed-encoder ArrowFlow trails the best tuned classical comparator on every dataset, and a second hidden layer did not improve accuracy.

An earlier version is available as arXiv:2604.04087v2, under the title *ArrowFlow: Hierarchical Machine Learning in the Space of Permutations*, last revised on 1 June 2026. The present submission provides revised analysis, nested evaluations, matched learning controls and the learned-encoder extension.

I confirm that neither the manuscript nor any parts of its content are currently under consideration for publication with or published in another journal. All authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission to MAKE.

The submission includes the main manuscript, supplementary material, LaTeX sources, a figure archive and a code supplement.

Sincerely,

Ozgur Yilmaz